

Design vs. Build Comparison Report: AUNTY D

Review Period: April 2026

Primary Reference: Loaning Website.pdf

Secondary Reference: Live Production Environment (Customer Frontend)

1. Executive Summary

The transition from the conceptual PDF to the live build has maintained a **high degree of fidelity** (estimated at **85-90%** alignment). The core user journey—moving from discovery (Home) to selection (Loan Types) and fulfillment (Multi-step Application)—remains identical to the original vision.

Key evolutions include the transition from generic branding to the **AUNTY D** identity and the replacement of static marketing placeholders with **live backend data**.

2. Branding & Information Architecture

The structural skeleton of the site remains largely unchanged, though some navigation elements were consolidated to improve the user experience.

Feature	Original Design (PDF)	Live Build Status
Identity	"LOAN" (Placeholder)	AUNTY D (Established Brand)
Slogan	"financialy Health"	Financial Health (Corrected)
Navigation	Home, About, Contact, Login	Home, Loan Types, Apply, Contact
Footer	"Help Centre" / "FAQ"	Structure remains; content is simplified

Note on Deviations: The standalone "About" and "Help Centre" pages were omitted in favor of a centralized Home experience. This was an intentional choice to reduce "click-fatigue" for new users.

3. Component-Level Alignment

3.1 The Home Page (Lead Generation)

The build successfully translates the marketing intent of the design into a functional application.

- Hero Section:** Retains the high-impact "Let’s Pay for that Vacation" headline.
- Dynamic Stats:** While the design used static figures (e.g., "18K clients"), the build pulls real-time data from the /loan/stats endpoint, showing **Live Applications** and **Total N\$ Loaned**.
- Office Finder:** The conceptual "Find Office" button is now a functional **Google Maps** integration.

3.2 The Loan Lifecycle (User Flow)

The "Apply" and "Status" sections represent the strongest alignment between the PDF and the code.

Phase	Alignment Score	Technical Implementation
Loan Selection	High	Cards for 1, 3, and 5-month terms match the PDF grid.
Application Flow	Very High	All PDF fields (Employment, Bank, Guarantors) are present in the Apply.tsx multi-step form.
Status Tracking	High	The UI uses the exact status vocabulary (Pending, Payback Ongoing, etc.) from the design.

4. Logical Gaps & Intentional Enhancements

During development, several features were added or modified to move the project from a "mockup" to a "production-ready" tool:

1. **Admin Infrastructure:** Not present in the original design, a full **Admin Dashboard** was built to allow staff to process the applications generated by the frontend.
2. **Document Security:** The "Documents" section (ID, Payslips) was integrated directly into the secure authenticated upload flow rather than being a generic profile list.
3. **Data Currency:** All currency references were localized to **N\$** to serve the Windhoek market, moving away from generic symbols used in the PDF.

5. Stakeholder Verdict

Alignment Rating: HIGH

The build is a **faithful execution** of the original design. The discrepancies noted (branding, consolidation of secondary pages, and dynamic stats) are standard industry progressions from design-to-code.

- **Integrity of Intent:** All core business goals defined in the PDF are met.
- **User Journey:** The path to a loan remains as intuitive as first envisioned.
- **Future Work:** If required, the "About" and "FAQ" routes can be built as separate modules using the existing layout components.